

NATURE OF RELIGIOUS LANGUAGE

OFFICIAL BOUNDARY AND THE → AQUINAS AND SCOTUS: CONTINUITY → TILlich: SYMBOL, PARTICIPATION AND → VERIFICATION, FALSIFICATION AND THE → BRAITHWAITE AND QUALIFIED WITTGENSTEINIAN → SPEECH ACTS, RAMSEY AND

Read the numbered rail in order. Every syllabus and PYQ-essential distinction is Core; the final grey node is genuinely optional enrichment.

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00 OFFICIAL BOUNDARY AND THE TWO-AXIS CONTROL

OFFICIAL BOUNDARY AND THE TWO-AXIS CONTROLGENERATED 2026-08-27APPROVAL FALSEOFFICIAL CLAUSEANALOGICAL AND SYMBOLIC; COGNITIVIST AND NON-COGNITIVEHOW DOES A PREDICATE REFER?DOES THE UTTERANCE STATE A TRUTH?

"GOD IS GOOD" MAY BE ANALOGICAL AND COGNITIVE AT

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- IDENTITY → learner-v2.g12
- generated 2026-08-27
- approval FALSE

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- OFFICIAL CLAUSE → analogical and symbolic; cognitivist and non-cognitive
- HOW DOES A PREDICATE REFER?
- DOES THE UTTERANCE STATE A TRUTH?

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- CONTROL → "God is good" may be ANALOGICAL and COGNITIVE at once.
- Never infer truth-status from semantic mode or semantic mode from use.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Separate semantic mode from truth-aptness: analogy or symbol explains how a statement signifies, not by itself whether it is true.

01

STAGE 01 AQUINAS AND SCOTUS: CONTINUITY WITHOUT COLLAPSE

AQUINAS AND SCOTUSCONTINUITY WITHOUT COLLAPSEPURE PERFECTION EXISTS IN GOD ESSENTIALLY AND EMINENTLY RESPERFECTION SIGNIFIED APPLIES TRULY TO GOD MODUS SIGNIFICANDICREATURE-DERIVED MANNER REMAINS INADEQUATEAQUINAS REJECTS

"GOD IS GOOD" MERELY MEANS GOD CAUSES GOODNESS LATERATTRIBUTION AND PROPORTIONALITY SYSTEMATISATION

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE

AQUINAS → pure perfection exists in God ESSENTIALLY AND EMINENTLY res significata = perfection signified applies truly to systematisation
God modus significandi = creature-derived manner remains inadequate

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

Aquinas REJECTS: "God is good" merely means God causes goodness later Thomist/Cajetan: attribution and proportionality systematisation
SCOTUS = semantic, NOT ontological, univocity secures valid inference one common concept; FINITE / INFINITE INTRINSIC MODES preserve the gulf

EVALUATION / TRAP

TRADE-OFF → univocity risks anthropomorphism; analogy risks indeterminacy.
AQUINAS → pure perfection exists in God ESSENTIALLY AND EMINENTLY res significata = perfection signified applies truly to

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE

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ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Aquinas preserves real predication through causal participation, while Scotus secures inference through semantic—not ontological—univocity.

02

STAGE 02 TILlich: SYMBOL, PARTICIPATION AND DISTORTION

SYMBOL, PARTICIPATION AND DISTORTIONCONVENTIONAL POINTER, REPLACEABLE, DOES NOT PARTICIPATEPOINTS + PARTICIPATES + OPENS REALITY/SELF + TRANSFORMS ARISESNOT ONE BEING; SYMBOLICALLY DISCLOSED AS BEING-ITSELFDISPUTED LIMIT

TILlich'S PROPOSED NON-SYMBOLIC ANCHOR WAS MODIFIEDFAILURE 1FINITE BEARER CLAIMS ULTIMACY

SIGN → conventional pointer, replaceable, does not participate

SYMBOL → points + PARTICIPATES + opens reality/self + transforms arises collectively + may grow

GOD → not one being; symbolically disclosed as BEING-ITSELF

DISPUTED LIMIT → Tillich's proposed non-symbolic anchor was modified

FAILURE 1 → finite bearer claims ultimacy = IDOLATRY / DEMONIC distortion

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- SIGN → conventional pointer, replaceable, does not participate
- SYMBOL → points + PARTICIPATES + opens reality/self + transforms arises collectively + may grow and die
- GOD → not one being; symbolically disclosed as BEING-ITSELF

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- DISPUTED LIMIT → Tillich's proposed non-symbolic anchor was modified
- FAILURE 1 → finite bearer claims ultimacy = IDOLATRY / DEMONIC distortion
- FAILURE 2 → unconstrained participation = vague or circular reference

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- VERDICT → symbolic realism needs participation and referential discipline.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Tillichian symbols participate and transform rather than merely point, but symbolic realism still owes a disciplined referent.

03

STAGE 03 VERIFICATION, FALSIFICATION AND THE COGNITIVE SPECTRUM

VERIFICATION, FALSIFICATION AND THE COGNITIVE SPECTRUMCOGNITIVE REALISMCLAIMS MAY BE TRUE OR FALSE; ANALOGY CAN QUALIFYUNVERIFIABLE THEOLOGY IS LITERALLY MEANINGLESSWHAT COULD COUNT AGAINST IT? DEATH BY A THOUSAND

NON-FACTUAL WORLD-ORIENTATION CAN STILL GOVERN LIFE

TRUTH-APT DEFEASIBLE TRUST ADMITS ADVERSE EVIDENCE

ESCHATOLOGICAL VERIFICATION

DOCTRINE / CLAIM

- COGNITIVE REALISM → claims may be true or false; analogy can qualify mode
- AYER → unverifiable theology is literally meaningless
- FLEW → what could count against it? death by a thousand qualifications

OBJECTION / PRESSURE

- HARE → blirk: non-factual world-orientation can still govern life
- MITCHELL → partisan: truth-apt DEFEASIBLE TRUST admits adverse evidence
- HICK → eschatological verification: confirmable at the journey's end

REPLY / RESIDUAL

- BRAITHWAITE → moral commitment; constructive, not Ayer's elimination
- CONTROL → unverifiability is not automatically a formal contradiction.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Ayer questions verification, Flew falsification, Hare offers bliks, Mitchell defeasible trust and Hick possible eschatological confirmation.

04

STAGE 04 BRAITHWAITE AND QUALIFIED WITTGENSTEINIAN USE

BRAITHWAITE AND QUALIFIED WITTGENSTEINIAN USE"GOD IS LOVE" AVOWS AN AGAPEISTIC MORAL POLICY STORIESCONDUCT; RISKWITTGENSTEIN'S LECTURES

LAST JUDGEMENT DIFFERS FROM ORDINARY PREDICTION

LATER WITTGENSTEINIANS

LANGUAGE-GAME, GRAMMAR AND FORM OF LIFE

D. Z. PHILLIPS

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- BRAITHWAITE → "God is love" avows an AGAPEISTIC MORAL POLICY stories sustain intention; strength = conduct; risk = reductionism
- WITTGENSTEIN'S LECTURES → Last Judgement differs from ordinary prediction
- LATER WITTGENSTEINIANS → language-game, grammar and form of life

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- D. Z. PHILLIPS → resisted reductionist/simple non-cognitivist labels
- OBJECTION → internal grammar can become fideistic insulation
- REPLY → use explains intelligibility, not automatic truth or immunity

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- VERDICT → practical force may supplement rather than erase assertion.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Braithwaite captures moral commitment and Wittgensteinian grammar captures life-orientation, but neither should erase believers' realist intent.

05

STAGE 05 SPEECH ACTS, RAMSEY AND MIMAMSA

SPEECH ACTS, RAMSEY AND MIMAMSALOCUTIONARY CONTENTILLOCUTIONARY FORCEPERLOCUTIONARY EFFECTSELF-INVOLVING LANGUAGE COMMITS SPEAKER AND CONSTITUTES RELATIONORDINARY MODEL + QUALIFIERDISCLOSURE SITUATION

VIDHI HAS PRIORITY IN DISCLOSING DHARMA; NOT ALL SASTRA

AUSTIN → locutionary content

illocutionary force

perlocutionary effect

EVANS → SELF-INVOLVING language commits speaker and constitutes relation

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- AUSTIN → locutionary content
- illocutionary force
- perlocutionary effect
- EVANS → SELF-INVOLVING language commits speaker and constitutes relation

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- RAMSEY → ordinary MODEL + QUALIFIER → disclosure situation
- MIMAMSA → VIDHI has priority in disclosing DHARMA
- not all sastra is grammatically imperative
- MANTRA functions as ritual instrument sabda-nyatva = eternity of word/sound and word-meaning relation

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- GRAMMARIANS → classical SPHOTA (sentence-whole disclosure), especially Bharthari
- CONTROL → performative force does not by itself cancel cognitive content.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Performative and self-involving force can supplement cognitive content; Ramsey's model-and-qualifier stretches ordinary language without equivocation.

06

STAGE 06 ADVAITA: NEGATION, INDICATION AND SUBLATION

NEGATION, INDICATION AND SUBLATIONSAT, BUT NON-OBJECTIFIABLE; WORDS TURN BACKNEITHER ABSOLUTELY REAL NOR UNREALNETI NETI (NOT THIS, NOT THAT)ELIMINATIVE REMOVAL OF FINITE LIMITSLAKSANA (INDIRECT INDICATION)RETAIN INTENDED IMPORT WHEN LITERAL SENSE FAILS

DISCARD INCOMPATIBLE CONNOTATIONS IN "TAT TVAM ASI"

BRAHMAN → SAT, but NON-OBJECTIFIABLE; words turn back

MAYA / WORLD-APPEARANCE → ANIRVACANIYA: neither absolutely real nor unreal

NETI NETI (not this, not that) → ELIMINATIVE removal of finite limits

LAKSANA (indirect indication) → retain intended import when literal sense fails

BHAGA-TYAGA → discard incompatible connotations in "tat tvam asi"

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- BRAHMAN → SAT, but NON-OBJECTIFIABLE; words turn back
- MAYA / WORLD-APPEARANCE → ANIRVACANIYA: neither absolutely real nor unreal
- NETI NETI (not this, not that) → ELIMINATIVE removal of finite limits

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- LAKSANA (indirect indication) → retain intended import when literal sense fails
- BHAGA-TYAGA → discard incompatible connotations in "tat tvam asi"
- SUBLATION → teaching language removes error like a thorn, then is cancelled

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- TRAP → never call Brahman neither real nor unreal in maya's technical sense.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Advaita negates and indirectly indicates, Ramanuja affirms real attributes, Buddhism uses conventional truth and Jainism qualifies standpoint.

07

STAGE 07 FROM SYMBOL TOWARD MYSTICISM: MECHANISM AND COUNTER-CASE

FROM SYMBOL TOWARD MYSTICISMECHANISM AND COUNTER-CASEAFFIRMATIVE ROUTE SYMBOL PARTICIPATESDRAWNS PRACTITIONER INBECOMES TRANSPARENTPOSSIBLE IMMEDIACY BEYOND MEDIATIONWAKING/DREAM/DEEP SLEEP

SOUNDLESS AMATRA

AFFIRMATIVE ROUTE symbol participates → draws practitioner in → becomes transparent

SELF-EFFACEMENT → possible IMMEDIACY beyond mediation

OMKARA: A-U-M → waking/dream/deep sleep → soundless AMATRA / TURIYA

COUNTER-CASE idolatry arrests

KATZ: symbols constitute experience

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- AFFIRMATIVE ROUTE symbol participates → draws practitioner in → becomes transparent
- SELF-EFFACEMENT → possible IMMEDIACY beyond mediation
- OMKARA: A-U-M → waking/dream/deep sleep → soundless AMATRA / TURIYA

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- COUNTER-CASE idolatry arrests
- KATZ: symbols constitute experience
- iconoclasm deletes ethics, inquiry and grace show NON-NECESSITY; no symbol guarantees mysticism

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- VERDICT → normal and powerful route, but neither necessary nor sufficient.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Symbol may lead toward mysticism by becoming self-effacing, but it can also arrest in literalism or constitute experience from the start.

08

STAGE 08 FOURTEEN VERIFIED PYQ DEMAND ROUTES

FOURTEEN VERIFIED PYQ DEMAND ROUTES2018 Q5(A) SECULAR/RELIGIOUS USEQ7(B) BRAITHWAITEQ8(C) SYMBOL MEDIATION2019 Q6(A) WHETHER AND HOW SYMBOL LEADS TO MYSTICISM2020 Q8(A) COGNITIVE CONTENT IN DETAIL2021 Q8(A) BRAITHWAITE NON-COGNITIVE

Q8(C) TILlich SYMBOLISM

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- 2018 Q5(a) secular/religious use
- Q7(b) Braithwaite
- Q8(c) symbol mediation
- 2019 Q6(a) whether AND how symbol leads to mysticism
- 2020 Q8(a) cognitive content in detail

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- 2021 Q8(a) Braithwaite non-cognitive
- Q8(c) Tillich symbolism
- 2022 Q5(e) "God exists": cognitive versus non-cognitive
- 2023 Q5(d) qualified Wittgenstein
- Q7(c) Tillich

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- 2024 Q5(e) analogy
- Q8(a) cognitive/non-cognitive plus contradiction 10+10
- 2025 Q5(b) symbolic? reasons
- Q8(c) Advaitic anirvacanyata
- CONTROL → obey directive, printed marks split and answer-specific mechanism.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: All fourteen PYQs require directive-specific mechanisms, exact attribution and separation of HOW from WHETHER.

09

STAGE 09 EXECUTABLE ANSWER SPINE, TRAPS AND QUALIFIED CONCLUSION

EXECUTABLE ANSWER SPINE, TRAPS AND QUALIFIED CONCLUSIONDEFINE THE EXACT DEMAND AND SEPARATE HOW FROM WHETHERDOCTRINE WITH NAMED MECHANISM, NOT A THINKER LISTONE CANONICAL EXAMPLE OR TEXT LOCUSSTRONGEST OBJECTION AT THE POINT WHERE IT BITES

PRESERVE THE THEORY'S GAIN WITHOUT DENYING ITS COST

INDIAN/WESTERN ONLY AS QUALIFIED STRUCTURAL COMPARISON

CAUSE-ONLY AQUINAS

OPEN → define the exact demand and separate HOW from WHETHER

MAP → doctrine with named mechanism, not a thinker list

EVIDENCE → one canonical example or text locus

TEST → strongest objection at the point where it bites

REPLY → preserve the theory's gain without denying its cost

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- OPEN → define the exact demand and separate HOW from WHETHER
- MAP → doctrine with named mechanism, not a thinker list
- EVIDENCE → one canonical example or text locus
- TEST → strongest objection at the point where it bites

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- REPLY → preserve the theory's gain without denying its cost
- COMPARE → Indian/Western only as qualified structural comparison
- TRAPS → cause-only Aquinas
- settled Wittgenstein

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- CLOSE → intelligible reference + apophatic humility + critical vulnerability
- FORMULA → qualified mixed realism, not literalism and not disguised silence.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The strongest verdict is mixed and vulnerable: assertoric, symbolic and performative language with apophatic limits and real defeaters.

E

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENTRADICAL ORTHODOXY AND THE GENEALOGY OF UNIVOCITYFICTIONALISM AND RELIGIOUS MAKE-BELIEVESPECIALIST METAPHOR DEBATESPLURALISM BRIDGERADICAL ORTHODOXY AND THE GENEALOGY OF UNIVOCITY SOME RADICAL

THIS IS A CONTESTED HISTORICAL THESIS, NOT THE COREUSE IT ONLY AS ONE OPTIONAL HISTORIOGRAPHIC CRITICISM AFTER

OPTIONAL SOURCE WITNESS

- Radical Orthodoxy and the genealogy of univocity
- Fictionalism and religious make-believe
- Specialist metaphor debates
- Pluralism bridge

ADVANCED OBJECTION

- Radical Orthodoxy and the genealogy of univocity Some Radical Orthodoxy readings connect Scotist univocity to later secular metaphysics.
- This is a contested historical thesis, not the Core meaning of Scotus's semantic univocity.
- Use it only as one optional historiographic criticism after accurately stating intrinsic finite/infinite modes.
- Fictionalism and religious make-believe Religious fictionalism treats theological narratives as practically or imaginatively useful without belief in their

COMPARATIVE NUANCE

- literal truth.
- it differs from Braithwaite's moral-conative account, Hare's blirk, error theory and ordinary symbolic realism.
- It is enrichment rather than a required answer to the official clause.
- Specialist metaphor debates Metaphor theories ask whether religious predicates create redescriptions rather than track an ordered metaphysical similarity.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.